Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 4 · Monday 15 March 2027 · P5

Lesson

Rehearse and choose one change

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Scheme outcome

Rehearse and refine our performance.

Today I can

I can rehearse my own part.

I can choose one cue or pose to change.

I can keep my choice in my arts log.

Prepare

For three or four pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

Available three-part story plan and real feedback from last week, if present.

Clear personal spaces or chairs for hand poses. All props and the den are imagined.

Keep today's choice and actual watcher comment for the next lesson. No device or costume is needed.

Cover route

Recover the real three-part story if available. Otherwise read the fresh den story in Starter and date the new work today. Model one cue change. Pupils rehearse, use a class or staff watcher's actual comment and test one cue or pose. Keep individual choices and feedback for tomorrow. Use the seven-stage 40-minute timings, accessible roles and the three-second comfortable freeze limit.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: We will rehearse The new den. You can keep or change your role. If the old plan is missing, we make a fresh three-part plan today. Our audience is the class and invited staff only, and you can rehearse with a staff member privately.

Look for: Each learner has a safe role and an available plan or a fresh route.

Fallback: Read the three parts aloud: want a den, space too small, choose a small den. Let the pupil point or direct one hand pose.

Check and response: A role may be acting, a seated pose, silent movement or directing. A missing old plan stays missing; date today's new work today.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: Use your real story from last week if it is here. This three-part den story is our fresh route if needed. Tell me which part you chose. You do not need to tell a story from your life.

Look for: Pupils identify their actual contribution and recover a workable order.

Fallback: Offer first, next or last, then show the chosen part seated.

Check and response: The new den is an invented story. The order is want a den, find the space too small, choose a smaller plan.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: In our first adult model, I give the last cue too soon. Then I try the same three parts again. I wait until the performers are ready before the last cue. I keep each freeze to three comfortable seconds and breathe as usual. The watcher says which version they could follow. This is a model, not your evidence.

Look for: Adult contrasts two trials with a single change in cue timing and uses a concrete watcher question.

Fallback: Use three hand poses from a chair. Ask the pupil to point to the cue that gives time to get ready.

Check and response: A cue after checking readiness can help the group change together. Check: What did I change? If the pupil names a different feature, repeat only the last transition slowly.

We do 6 minutes

Say: We will do the story once before deciding. The watcher names a part they saw or could not yet see. We pick one change, such as waiting for the cue or turning the last pose. Let each pupil make a real choice. If the order is still unclear, rehearse first, next and last before adding a change.

Look for: The group bases one manageable target on a real trial and each pupil contributes or confirms a decision.

Fallback: Adult is the watcher and models only the first part; pupils direct the next cue or choose between two poses.

Check and response: If the watcher can name the first and last parts, test one feature. If not, return to the three-part order. This is the hinge decision; do not pile on several targets.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use the real plan or the fresh den story. Rehearse once, choose a cue or pose change, then try again. A director can choose when the cue comes; a seated or silent performer can choose a clear hand shape. The watcher is a class member or invited staff member. Keep the real comment, even if the change does not help yet.

Look for: Each learner makes or directs an actual rehearsal contribution, tests one change and records a confirmed choice.

Fallback: Use a staff-only seated trial. The pupil directs the adult with a point to the next cue word; record the instruction actually given.

Check and response: Example only: I waited for the group before my cue. The watcher saw us end together. A pupil may instead discover that the cue needs another try; that is useful evidence too.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Ask the maker whether the comment matches their aim. Use the last two minutes to relax, reset chairs and store the plan and feedback for tomorrow. The record should say what actually happened, not that the show is finished.

Look for: Learner confirms actual feedback and identifies one feature to keep or revisit.

Fallback: Staff member reads back the pupil's choice and the witnessed response. The pupil can correct either.

Check and response: A useful comment names a cue, pose or clear story part. Good acting alone does not tell the maker what helped.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Date the rehearsal today. I can write your words, read them back and let you change them. Keep the real target for tomorrow. If we did not finish a trial, say that and plan the next step.

Look for: Dated log separates the actual role, tested change, response and next step.

Fallback: Offer cue or pose as a choice and scribe the confirmed words.

Check: Example only: I tried a slow cue. The watcher saw the last pose. Tomorrow I will check we all wait for the cue.

Evidence and review

Keep the available earlier plan with its original date, a new dated rehearsal note, the actual feedback and each learner's confirmed choice and reason. Show the part before and after a change when possible. Record support and any unfinished work honestly. Fresh work is dated today. A photograph or recording is optional under local consent procedures and is not needed.

Misconceptions

Refine means change the whole story - Keep the three story parts. Test one cue or pose.

A rehearsal must work first time - A trial can show what needs another try. Keep the real result.

Only a speaking actor has a role - Acting seated, silent movement and directing can each include a real creative choice.

Questions

foundation: Which part will we try again?

middle: What one thing did we change?

higher: What did the watcher see that helps us judge the change?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Keep a clear personal space. Walk only; no running, lifting, falls, climbing, throws or contact. Props and scenery are imagined. Use an agreed open-hand stop cue. A freeze lasts at most three comfortable seconds, with normal breathing, then relax. Seated and hand-only versions are equal options.

Emotional and sensory access

Use invented situations and role labels. Offer actor, seated performer, silent performer or director. No forced speech, public performance, eye contact, personal account or touch. Agree a calm space, stop cue and return cue. A rehearsal may be shared privately with a trusted member of staff.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Keep three BUILD parts or four GROW beats visible in a book or cue note. Rehearse once before changing one thing. Read one feedback point, model the first step only, then return the choice to the learner.

Communication And Interaction: Use short cue words or point to a cue word. Reserve the open hand for Stop. Offer pointing, signing, a seated gesture, silent acting, directing or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use We changed ... because ... .

Semh: Use the familiar invented scene when available and offer an honest fresh route. Agree roles and audience privately. A pause, smaller movement, role change or private staff rehearsal is valid. Do not measure confidence or require disclosure.

Sensory And Physical: Use a chair or hands only. Agree safe space and a quiet cue. Keep voices at talking level. No touch or surprise sounds. A still pose lasts only up to three comfortable seconds while breathing normally.

Eal: Plan in any language. Link each cue word to a gesture. Allow oral rehearsal before a short log. Check meaning, sequence and the learner's intended change rather than accent or spelling.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. The optional GROW next level stretch adds evidence for later review. This is rehearsal and refinement; next week is performance and review. These lessons do not complete or certify the award.

Resilience can include pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying a manageable next step. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or continuing through pain.